

Day 7 — Primary Source: Bhagavad-gītā 6.17

Module: Ayurveda (Middle) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students read BG 6.17 in IAST + translation, identify the five activities Krishna names as needing regulation, and connect each to a dinacharya practice.

Materials

- Printed handout: BG 6.17 (Sanskrit, IAST, word-by-word, translation, brief commentary)

Flow

Warm-up (5 min)

Daily prompt + recall: dinacharya practice they tried.

Reading (20 min)

yuktāhāra-vihārasya yukta-ceṣṭasya karmasu yukta-svapnāvabodhasya yogo bhavati duḥkha-hā — Bhagavad-gītā 6.17

Word-by-word:

Sanskrit	Gloss
yukta	regulated, balanced, joined
āhāra	food
vihārasya	of recreation, lifestyle (gen.)
yukta-ceṣṭasya	of regulated effort/activity (gen.)
karmasu	in work, actions (loc.)
yukta-svapna	regulated sleep
avabodhasya	of waking (gen.)
yogo	yoga, discipline
bhavati	becomes
duḥkha-hā	sorrow-destroying

Continuous translation: > “He who is regulated in eating and recreation, in his effort in work, in his sleep and waking — for him, yoga becomes the destroyer of sorrow.”

The five activities (10 min)

Krishna names FIVE activities that need regulation: 1. *Āhāra* — eating 2. *Vihāra* — recreation, lifestyle 3. *Ceṣṭā in karma* — effort in work 4. *Svapna* — sleep 5. *Avabodha* — waking

Now connect to dinacharya: - *Āhāra* → eating timing + six tastes (Day 6) - *Vihāra* → exercise (vyāyāma) + leisure - *Ceṣṭā in karma* → balanced effort, neither lazy nor over-exerted - *Svapna* → sleep by 10pm - *Avabodha* → waking before sunrise (brāhma muhūrta)

Note: the verse is from the *Bhagavad-gītā*, a philosophical-spiritual text. It frames regulated living as the foundation for *yoga* (the discipline of mind). Ayurveda picks up this same framework on the body-health side.

Discussion (8 min)

- Question: “Which of the five activities do you find HARDEST to regulate in your own life?”
- Take 4 student answers.

Wrap-up (2 min)

- Preview Day 8: “Tomorrow — start designing your own 7-day dinacharya.”

Homework

- Pick ONE of the five activities. Notice it tomorrow. Are you “yukta” (regulated) or out of balance?

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read Bryant (2009) commentary on BG 6.17.
- **Tier down:** Memorise the 5 activities only.

Teacher notes

- BG is a religious text for many traditions. Honour that. Here we use it as a primary source for the lifestyle-regulation principle.
- The “yoga destroys sorrow” line is profound; let it land without over-interpretation.

Citation(s) used

- BG 6.17 — vidya-karana RAG cache `day-04-dinacharya.json#chunks[0]`.
- Bryant (2009) for Sāṅkhya-Yoga commentary on BG.